FinWise AI: AI-Powered Personal Financial Advisor

FinWise AI — Personal Financial Advisor for ASEAN Communities

Case Study:

BorNEO Hack Weekend Case Study 7
Artificial Intelligence for Financial Education and Robo-Advisory Systems

Sustainable Development Goal (SDG):

SDG 8: Decent Work and Economic Growth

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1.0 INTRODUCTION

1.1 Background of Case Study

Personal financial management is an essential skill in modern society. However, many individuals, especially students and young adults, struggle to manage their finances effectively. Common challenges include overspending, lack of budgeting discipline, insufficient savings, and limited understanding of financial planning. These challenges are particularly evident across Southeast Asia, where financial literacy levels vary significantly between countries and communities.

Within the ASEAN region, many individuals are entering the digital economy without adequate financial education. While mobile banking and digital payment systems are becoming increasingly common, users often lack the knowledge required to manage their finances responsibly. This situation creates a need for accessible tools that can support individuals in understanding their financial behavior and making better financial decisions.

With the advancement of digital technologies and artificial intelligence, financial management tools can now provide smarter and more personalized assistance to users. Artificial intelligence has the ability to analyze financial data, identify spending patterns, and generate practical financial recommendations.

FinWise AI is an AI-powered financial assistant designed to support individuals across ASEAN countries by helping them track expenses, analyze financial habits, and receive personalized financial advice. The system aims to promote financial literacy and responsible financial behavior through a simple and accessible digital platform.

1.2 Chosen Sustainable Development Goal (SDG)

This project aligns itself with Sustainable Development Goal 8: Decent Work and Economic Growth. Sustainable Development Goal 8 focuses on promoting sustainable economic growth, financial stability, and productive employment opportunities. Financial literacy and effective money management are important aspects that define a financially stable economy. People who are aware of how to manage their earnings and expenses tend to live a stable life and contribute to the growth of the economy.

FinWise AI contributes to this goal by promoting financial awareness and effective financial practices among users in ASEAN societies.

1.3 Problem Statement

Many people in the ASEAN countries are not aware of the necessary knowledge and skills that help them manage their finances effectively. This has led to a number of problems, including overspending, insufficient savings, and planning for future financial needs. This problem has greatly affected young people in the country, especially students.

Although there are a number of financial management applications that help people manage their finances effectively, most of these applications are not suitable for the people in the ASEAN countries. This is because most of these applications are complex and require a high level of financial knowledge or do not provide financial guidance suitable for the people in the ASEAN countries. This has led to a need for a simple, intelligent, and accessible financial management application that

helps users in the ASEAN countries manage their finances effectively. In addition, most people in the country cannot afford professional financial advice.

Therefore, there is a need for a simple, intelligent, and accessible financial management application that helps users in the ASEAN countries manage their finances effectively.

1.4 Objectives

The objectives of the FinWise AI project are:

- To create a financial management system that enables users to manage their daily expenses.
- To analyze users' spending habits and offer them financial insights that enable them to understand their spending habits.
- To offer users financial advice through an AI-powered financial advisor that helps users make informed financial decisions.
- To promote users' savings habits by helping them set financial goals.
- To increase users' financial literacy in the ASEAN region through financial advice offered in various languages.

2.0 REVIEW OF EXISTING SOLUTIONS

There are already a number of financial management application systems available in the market that provide different features like expense management, budgeting, etc. For instance, there are financial management applications like Mint, YNAB (You Need A Budget), etc., which provide useful features for financial management that help users manage their expenses effectively.

Despite these features, there are a number of limitations that exist in the existing financial management application systems that can be used by the users in the ASEAN countries. For instance, some of these systems are complex and require a high level of financial knowledge. This creates difficulties for users, especially young users, to understand these complex features.

Furthermore, most financial management application systems are based on expense management rather than providing users with relevant financial insights. For instance, most systems do not provide users with interactive AI assistants that help them answer their financial-related queries or provide them with relevant advice on improving their financial skills.

Another limitation is that it is not region-inclusive. This is because the applications are mostly not developed with the Southeast Asian population in mind. Therefore, the applications may not take into consideration the financial habits of the Southeast Asian population.

FinWise AI is a simple financial assistant that is AI-powered. The platform is designed to help users with expense management, analysis, and recommendations. The platform is developed with the ASEAN population in mind. The platform is accessible, inclusive, and educational.

3.0 METHODOLOGY

This project follows a non-technical approach for preliminary round. The development of FinWise AI was carried out with a design thinking approach, which ensures that the system addresses the actual user needs as well as provides a good user experience for the users.

The first step was to understand the financial challenges faced by students and young adults living in the ASEAN region. This step provided insights into the challenges faced by users, including a lack of financial literacy, unstructured spending habits, and a lack of access to financial information.

The second step was to identify the key problem, which is the lack of simple financial tools that can give users personalized financial advice. In the ideation phase, several features were developed, including expense tracking, AI financial advice, financial health scores, tracking of savings goals, as well as multilingual capabilities.

In the prototype phase, the user interface was developed using Figma, which included several features, including the dashboard, expense tracking, AI chat, savings goal tracking, as well as user profile settings.

Finally, the prototype was tested by simulating user interactions with the system, which ensures that the user interface is simple enough for users with varying levels of financial knowledge.

4.0 RESULTS

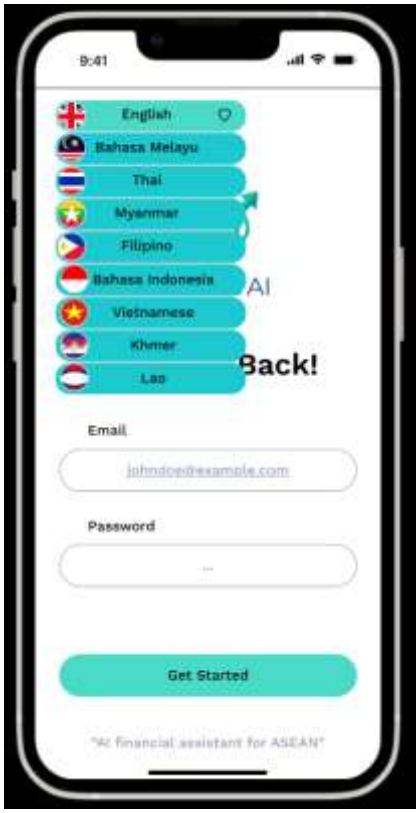
The FinWise AI prototype is successful in demonstrating the application of artificial intelligence technology to the management of personal finance among the ASEAN communities. The AI system enables the user to log their daily expenses and organize the expenses under specific headings such as "food," "transport," "shopping," etc. These headings are relevant to the lifestyle of the people in Southeast Asia.

The AI assistant enables the user to pose questions on finance, providing them with personalized financial advice based on their income, expenses, and savings. This is a unique feature of the AI system, providing the user with a financial advisor to make better financial decisions. The application provides a financial health score to the user to assess their financial condition on the basis of factors such as "spending control," "savings rate," "emergency fund," etc.

The other features of the application are the savings goal tracker, financial notifications, AI assistant in multiple languages, dark mode interface, etc. These features make the application more efficient and accommodating to the needs of the users. The AI prototype is successful in achieving the objectives set by the project.

5.0 PROTOTYPE SHOWCASE

The FinWise AI prototype developed is a mobile app interface where the focus is on simplicity and usability to cater to the needs of ASEAN users. The app is planned and designed to work in all main ASEAN languages. The user can change language according to their preferred ASEAN language and the currency display will change according to their nation.



The login interface shows the Finwise AI logo. It has a language drop down button on the top left of the screen which allows the user to choose their preferred ASEAN language. The user needs to enter their email, password and click the blue button at the bottom of the screen to log into the application.

The dashboard is the homepage of the app that is linked with all features in the app which you can access with a single click. It is linked with the financial health interface, add expense interface, AI assistant interface, insights interface, savings goals interface, notification interface and profile interface. The dashboard also has a toggle button to switch from light mode to dark mode.

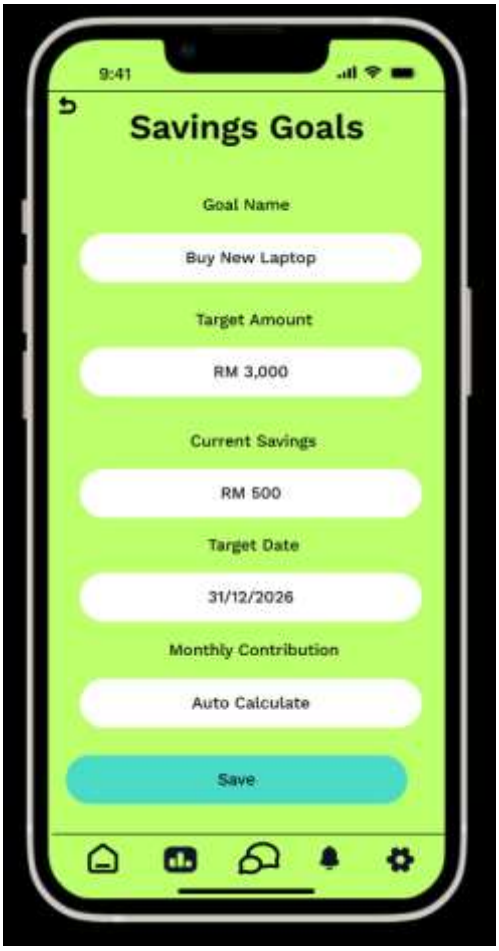
The financial health interface shows the user's overall score and indicators to describe and justify the score received.

The insights interface shows the user's monthly spending according to the year chosen and by categories of expenses as well.

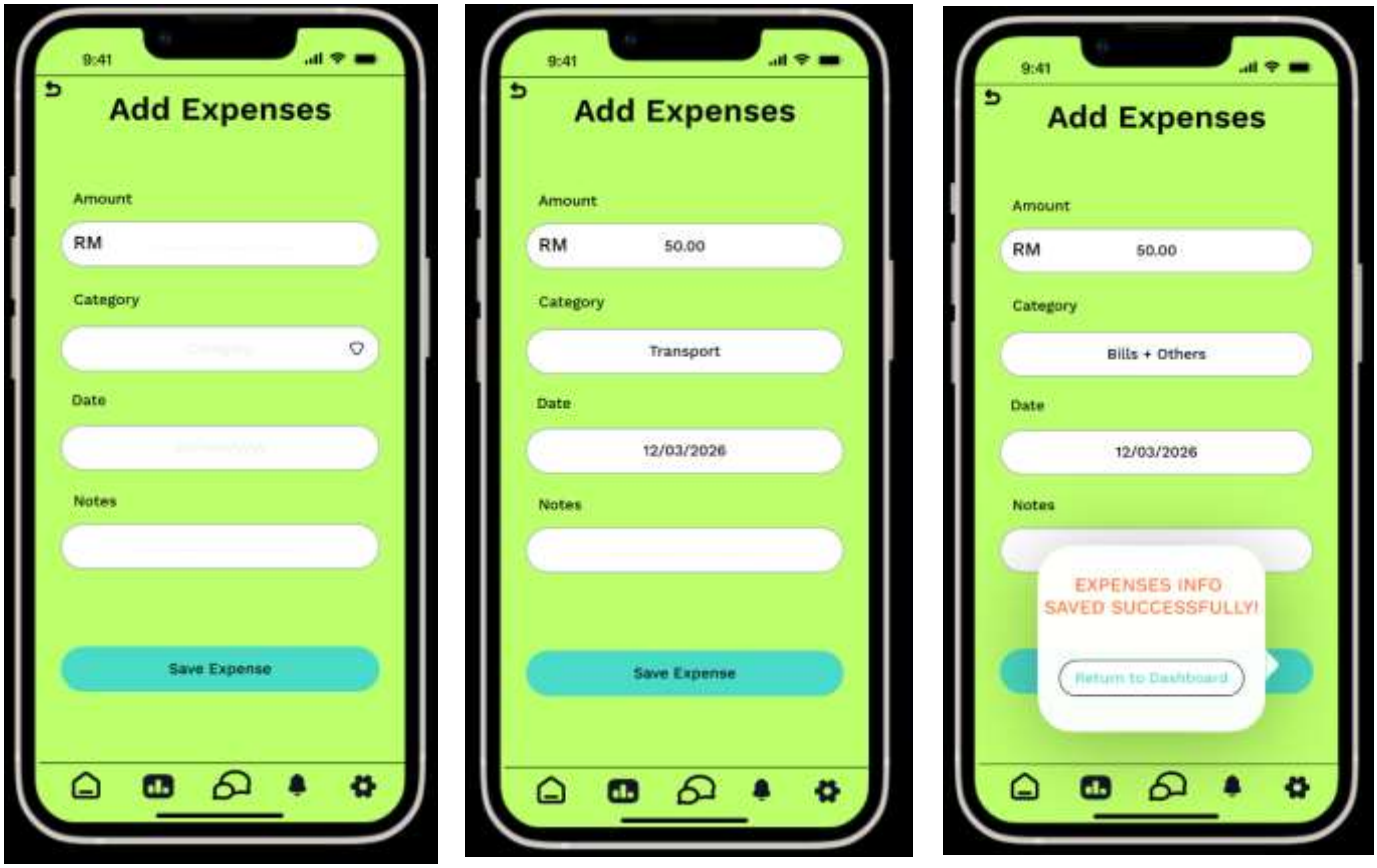
The AI assistant interface has an AI avatar and a language drop down button at the top half of the screen. The AI assistant works in all main ASEAN languages. It also gives some suggested questions for the user to choose or they can manually type in their questions as well. After providing replies, the AI assistant also gives suggested actions for the user to take.

The profile and settings interface enables the user to set preferences such as language selection and dark mode. The users can also insert their name, profile image, phone number, email and country. They can access the notification interface from this interface and are able to log out from the application as well.

The notification interface shows all notifications received by the user in terms of old and new notifications. The user can read the entire description or information about each notification by clicking on the specific notification.



The savings goals interface stores all goals created by the user in a card element, which shows the goal name, amount and progress of the user. When creating a new goal, the user can set a target date and ask the application to auto-calculate their monthly contribution to reach the target.



The add expenses interface allows the user to add their daily expenses in terms of amount, category and date. The sure can add notes if they want to.

The interface screenshots briefly explain how the application can be used to assist users in financial tracking, analysis, and decision-making. A detailed demo video of the prototype is submitted together with this report, which is accessible in the github repository of the project.

6.0 AI ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

Disclosure: Throughout the creation of the project, artificial intelligence tools were utilized for the purpose of aiding with idea generation, documentation creation, and design development.

Usage: ChatGPT was utilized for the purpose of aiding with the creation of the project plan and guiding through Figma designing (ChatGPT was used to guide on how to create dropdowns and dark mode features in Figma)

AI image generation tool, Gemini, was utilized for the creation of the FinWise AI logo and the AI assistant avatar which are used within the application prototype.

7.0 CONCLUSION

FinWise AI is an example of how artificial intelligence can be used to improve personal financial management and financial literacy for ASEAN people. The system offers users a chance to understand their financial behavior better by incorporating expense tracking and financial analysis into one platform.

The prototype emphasizes the need for financial technology to be accessible to all people, regardless of their cultural or financial differences. FinWise AI is an example of how financial technology can be made accessible to people of different cultural backgrounds.

In the future, the system could be further enhanced by incorporating real-time banking data, financial analytics, and region-specific financial information relevant to different ASEAN countries. This will enable the FinWise AI system to evolve into a fully functional financial technology platform that has the potential for supporting financial stability and economic growth in the region.